Brand Design System

Human instructions

This document is the human-readable companion to the Skillit Brand Design System. The system itself lives as a machine-readable token library — this is the translation of those rules into graphical form, for anyone at Skillit who creates something on behalf of the brand. Designers, marketers, writers, agency partners, and anyone who has ever asked “does this look right?” — this is for you.

Canvas
#FAF7F3
2, 2, 4, 0
Paper

Background

Plaster
#FFFFFF
0, 0, 0, 0
None

Surface

Iron
#232F36
80, 50, 45, 65
Pantone 432 C

Foreground

Traffic Cone
#EF6F1A
0, 65, 100, 0
Pantone 158 C

CTA

Hard Hat
#FEB11C
0, 30, 100, 0
Pantone 1235 C

Warning

Toolbox
#C8102E
2, 100, 85, 6
Pantone 186 C

Error

Bottle Glass
#367C2B
75, 15, 100, 10
Pantone 364 C

Success

Painter's Tape
#007CA6
100, 30, 10, 10
Pantone 3135 C

Link

SKILLIT

Work Sans	**64px/48pt**	**Semibold (600)**	**-4%**	**1.0**
Work Sans	32px/24pt	Medium (500)	-2%	1.2
Work Sans	16px/12pt	Regular (400)	0%	1.4
Work Sans	12px/9pt	Regular (400)	0%	1.55

Typography

Work Sans only. Sentence-case everywhere. No all-caps. Flush-left alignment. Dramatic leaps in scale.

Accent

Traffic Cone. Use it exactly *once* per layout section. Never for decoration.

Copy

Direct, unhedged, data-backed. Don’t say things like “revolutionize” or “disrupt.”

Layout

Strict functionalism. Whitespace is structural mass. Canvas background, Iron text. No decoration.

Photos

Real workers doing real work. Shot at eye level. No color grading or filters.

Rule

Start from the worker’s perspective.

The Brand Story

Skillit is workforce infrastructure.

When you create assets for Skillit, you are designing for a specific, misunderstood reality: the physical world tracks materials, schedules, and budgets with extraordinary precision, but it doesn't track the people doing the work.

Our data proves that only 1 in 20 workers are missing from the labor force, yet 9 in 10 employers can't find them. **This is an access problem, not a shortage problem.**

Your job is to communicate that truth. Our visuals and copy must project infrastructure-level reliability to contractors, while maintaining absolute respect and dignity for the craft worker. Everything we make must reflect our founding reality: **we are builders who built tech**, not a software company that discovered construction.

The Mission

Technology should make humans more essential, not more expendable.

This is our anchor. Every design decision, every piece of copy, and every product interaction must pass this test. If an asset diminishes the worker, makes them look like a corporate resource, or relies on tech-utopian AI hype, revise it.

Worker First. The brand is built around the worker, not the contractor. The contractor is our customer, but the worker is our subject. When in doubt, frame the design and the message from the worker's perspective.

Colors

The Skillit palette is **Materials on Site** — eight colors named for the physical materials workers handle every day. Each color has one job. Use it for that job only.

Canvas
#FAF7F3
2, 2, 4, 0
Paper
Primary background

Plaster
#FFFFFF
0, 0, 0, 0
Paper
Surfaces, cards background

Iron
#232F36
80, 50, 45, 65
Pantone 432 C
Primary foreground, structural elements

Traffic Cone
#EF6F1A
0, 65, 100, 0
Pantone 158 C
Primary CTA, active states, key accents

Hard Hat
#FEB11C
0, 30, 100, 0
Pantone 1235 C
Warnings, non-fatal alerts

Toolbox
#C8102E
2, 100, 85, 6
Pantone 186 C
Errors, destructive actions

Bottle Glass
#367C2B
75, 15, 100, 10
Pantone 364 C
Success, confirmations

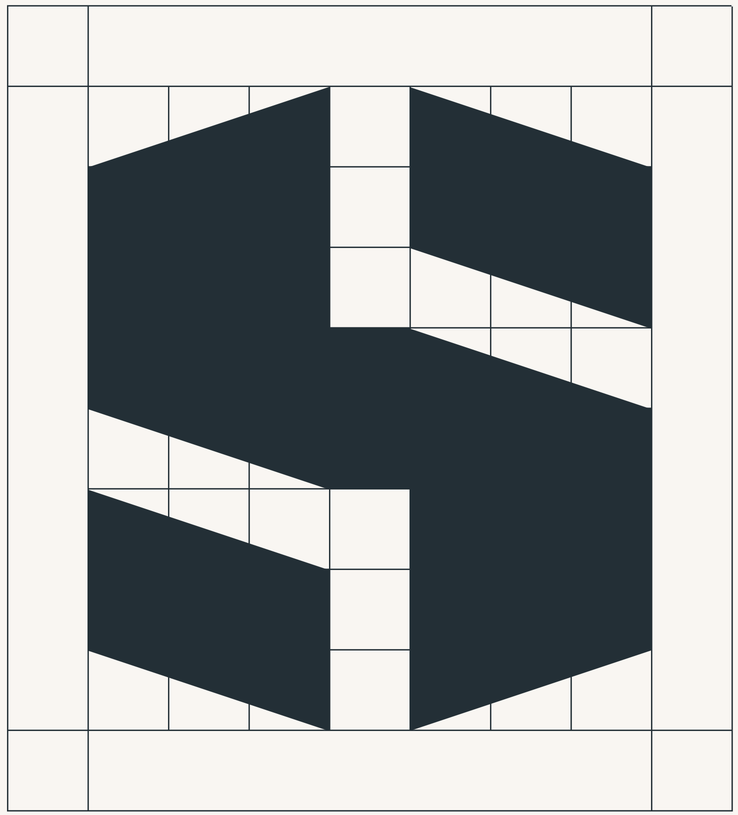
Painter’s Tape
#007CA6
100, 30, 10, 10
Pantone 3135 C
Underlined text links only

Do

- Use Traffic Cone once per section, on the most important element.
- Use Iron on Canvas for all body text.
- Pair every status color with a shape and a label.

Don’t

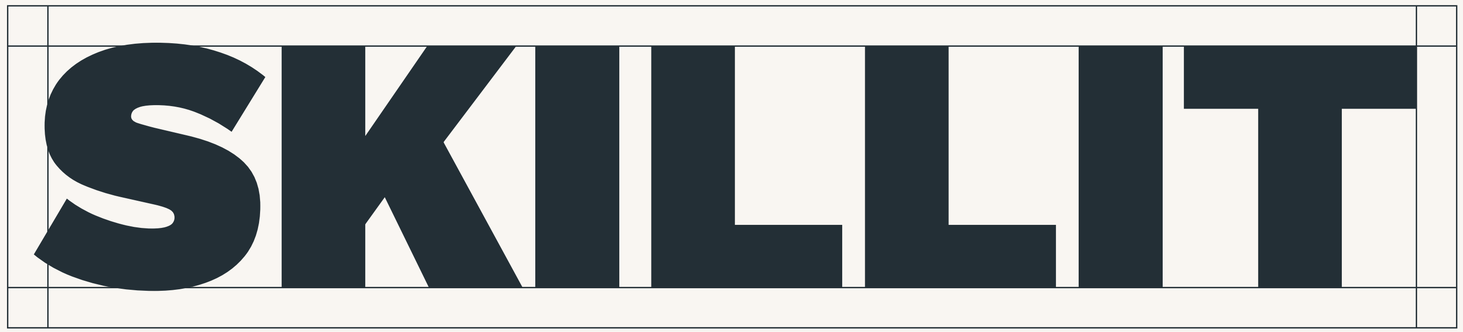
- Don’t repeat Traffic Cone decoratively across borders, icons, and dividers.
- Don’t use Traffic Cone text on Canvas backgrounds at body size.
- Don’t rely on color alone to communicate error, warning, or success.
- Don’t use gradients — all color transitions should be hard edges.
- Don’t use Hard Hat, Toolbox, Bottle Glass, or Painter’s Tape as layout backgrounds or decorative elements.
- Don’t use Painter’s Tape as a button fill — it is for underlined text links only.
- Don’t introduce any color outside the eight.



The Skillit mark is the brand’s initial “S” engineered for physical grip. Built from three interlocking blocks on a precise 1:3 shear, the geometry acts as a boot tread, machinery tracks, or diamond plate steel. It encodes traction, structural integrity, and forward momentum into a single form. It does not require the wordmark to be understood.

Grid: 7×8 unit grid. One unit of clear space on all sides — protected area of 9×10 units.

Minimum size: 24px/18pt height. Below this threshold the internal negative space closes up and the mark loses definition.



The wordmark is set in Work Sans Black, all-caps, with –3% tracking. It is a fixed graphic asset, not a line of text.

Minimum size: 18px/13.5pt height.

Clear space: Maintain a minimum clear space equal to the cap height of the wordmark on all sides. Never crowd it against an edge, another logo, or a photographic element.

The lockup is the mark and wordmark together. It is the primary logo — use it wherever possible.

Horizontal lockup only. The mark sits to the left of the wordmark, aligned to the cap height, with 2 units of space between them.

Minimum size: 24px/18pt height (mark at 24px/18pt, wordmark at 18px/13.5pt).

Clear space: Maintain a minimum clear space of 2 units on all sides of the lockup. Never crowd it against an edge, another logo, or an image.

Do

Iron on Canvas: Default — all light backgrounds

Canvas on Iron: Dark backgrounds, inverted surfaces

Iron on Traffic Cone: use sparingly

Single color outline: Print, embroidery, engraving

Don’t

Stretch/compress

Shear

Rotate

Apply drop shadows

Apply outlines

Apply textures

Blur

Crop

Use legacy versions

Use raster formats (BMP, JPG, PNG)

Recreate the mark, wordmark, or lockup

Place on images without sufficient contrast

The Skillit pattern is a step-and-repeat tessellation of the boot tread mark. Because the mark's negative space is designed as an interlocking joint, the repeated pattern locks together to form a structural, masonry-like wall. It is the only decorative graphic in the system.

- **Structural anchor:** headers, footers.
- **Physical applications:** debossed into leather, printed on packaging interiors, or as a watermark on documents.

Don’t

Fill with any accent color

Place under running text

Scale it up as a hero graphic

Place it on photography

Icono-graphy

All icons are drawn on a 24×24px canvas using a 10×10 sub-grid where one block equals 2px. Solid fill only. No strokes, no outlines, no gradients, no drop shadows, 0px corner radius on all geometry. Status never relies on color alone:
Success = Circle, Warning = Triangle, Error = Octagon.

Typo-graphy

Skillit uses one typeface: **Work Sans**. Designed by Australian designer Wei Huang and inspired by early twentieth-century Grotesque typefaces, it is warm, direct, and legible — the same values as the brand. It is free and open-source, available on Google Fonts, Adobe Fonts, and GitHub.

Title

Heading

Subheading

Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet, consectetur adipiscing elit. Integer felis augue, vehicula eget suscipit vel, commodo et arcu. Phasellus hendrerit consequat ipsum ut tempor. Ut a ullamcorper elit, quis bibendum odio. Maecenas sed tellus mi. Phasellus vitae dolor euismod, euismod ante eu, hendrerit elit. Fusce lobortis libero eget nisl volutpat imperdiet. Donec eget felis dignissim, varius eros quis, molestie ex. Aenean ac neque augue. Morbi aliquam nisi id placerat ultricies.

Etiam quis nulla vitae lacus eleifend ornare vel non nunc. Proin in ligula quis magna condimentum condimentum. Integer commodo nisi nisl, at tempus nunc ornare quis. Suspendisse vel dapibus nisi. Vestibulum vitae sapien imperdiet, fermentum sem in, interdum arcu. Nunc vel quam sem. Donec a imperdiet odio, at mattis tortor. Curabitur sed dapibus sapien. Sed iaculis lacus neque, sed suscipit sapien vestibulum sed. Phasellus sagittis quis lectus ac maximus. Sed venenatis nulla at nulla blandit, ac finibus massa lobortis.

The typography system is mathematically derived. Levels are named objectively by their pixel size.

The scale is a perfect factor-of-2 progression built on a 16px baseline: 128 → 64 → 32 → 16, with the addition of a smaller 12px caption level.

Work Sans Bold (700) 128px/96pt -6% 1.2

Work Sans Semibold (600) 64px/48pt -4% 1.0

Work Sans Medium (500) 32px/24pt -2% 1.2

Work Sans Regular (400) 16px/12pt 0% 1.4

Work Sans Regular (400) 12px/9pt 0% 1.55

Work Sans is a **variable font** with a continuous weight axis (100–900).

Optical correction: Light text on a dark background creates an optical illusion (halation) that makes letterforms appear heavier than they are. Two techniques reduce this:

- **On light backgrounds:** Use standard weights (400, 500, 600, 700). Canvas is already an off-white rather than pure white, which naturally reduces irradiation against dark type.
- **On dark backgrounds:** Subtract **~25 units** of font weight (375, 475, 575, 675). The goal is to make the text read as the same apparent weight as it would on a light background.

Heading (600)

Subheading (500)

Body (400). Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet, consectetur adipiscing elit. Integer felis augue, vehicula eget suscipit vel, commodo et arcu. Phasellus hendrerit consequat ipsum ut tempor. Ut a ullamcorper elit, quis bibendum odio. Maecenas sed tellus mi. Phasellus vitae dolor euismod, euismod ante eu, hendrerit elit. Fusce lobortis libero eget nisl volutpat imperdiet. Donec eget felis dignissim, varius eros quis, molestie ex.

Heading (600)

Subheading (500)

Body (400). Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet, consectetur adipiscing elit. Integer felis augue, vehicula eget suscipit vel, commodo et arcu. Phasellus hendrerit consequat ipsum ut tempor. Ut a ullamcorper elit, quis bibendum odio. Maecenas sed tellus mi. Phasellus vitae dolor euismod, euismod ante eu, hendrerit elit. Fusce lobortis libero eget nisl volutpat imperdiet. Donec eget felis dignissim, varius eros quis, molestie ex.